

Step 2: Multi-Mission Search

Find every available scene from six satellite missions over your AOI and date range.

This step searches Sentinel-1, Sentinel-2, Landsat 8/9, NISAR, MODIS, and Sentinel-6 for your AOI and date range, pulling each from wherever it actually lives — Google Earth Engine for what's in its catalog, and each mission's real NASA archive for what isn't.

Picking a date range

Start with something generous (60–90 days) — narrow it down once you see how many scenes come back. A very short window can easily return zero results for tasked/less-frequent sensors even though data exists just outside your window.

Why a sensor might show zero results

Sensor	Common reason for 0 results
Sentinel-1	Acquisition is tasked by ESA, not automatic — your AOI may simply not be in the current observation plan for that date range
Sentinel-6	Ocean-only altimetry mission — always 0 for a land AOI, this is correct
NISAR	Still in early commissioning phase with limited coverage as of this writing

None of these are bugs — they reflect what each mission actually collected. Widen the date range or check the Live Tracker step for an independent, orbit-physics-based cross-check.

Filtering results

- **Minimum AOI coverage %** — drop scenes that only clip a corner of your AOI.
- **Maximum cloud cover %** — only applies to optical sensors (Sentinel-2, Landsat); radar (Sentinel-1, NISAR) and MODIS rows pass through regardless, since cloud cover doesn't block them the same way.

■ **Tip** — Save the filtered CSV before moving to the Download step — that CSV is what the download step actually reads.